

ment, given that infrastructure has a double multiplier effect on the economy. Recent relaxations in Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) policies and production-linked incentive (PLI) schemes have made India an attractive destination for global investors. The focus has been on creating a conducive environment for business, reducing bureaucratic hurdles, and encouraging entrepreneurship. The government's Make in India campaign has already created a strong impact in the form of an improved business environment and economic growth. A well-laid infrastructure network will not only boost economic activities but also improve the quality of life for the country's citizens.

Developing human capital

96 | Over the coming years, the focus must be on getting a significant portion of the population into the workforce, as it is an untapped reservoir of energy, innovation, and skill. We must accelerate the wheels of skill development and job creation. The government's Skill Development Cell has taken on the responsibility of training youth by providing them with skills through various schemes. In addition, the private sector is also harnessing its people's power, expertise and network to make education more accessible to children, especially in the remote parts of our country. I believe all these initiatives will equip the workforce with the necessary skills to be highly competitive in the global economy.

Universal health coverage

Lastly, a healthy population is fundamental to a country's growth and productivity. Strengthening healthcare systems involves expanding coverage, improving service qual-

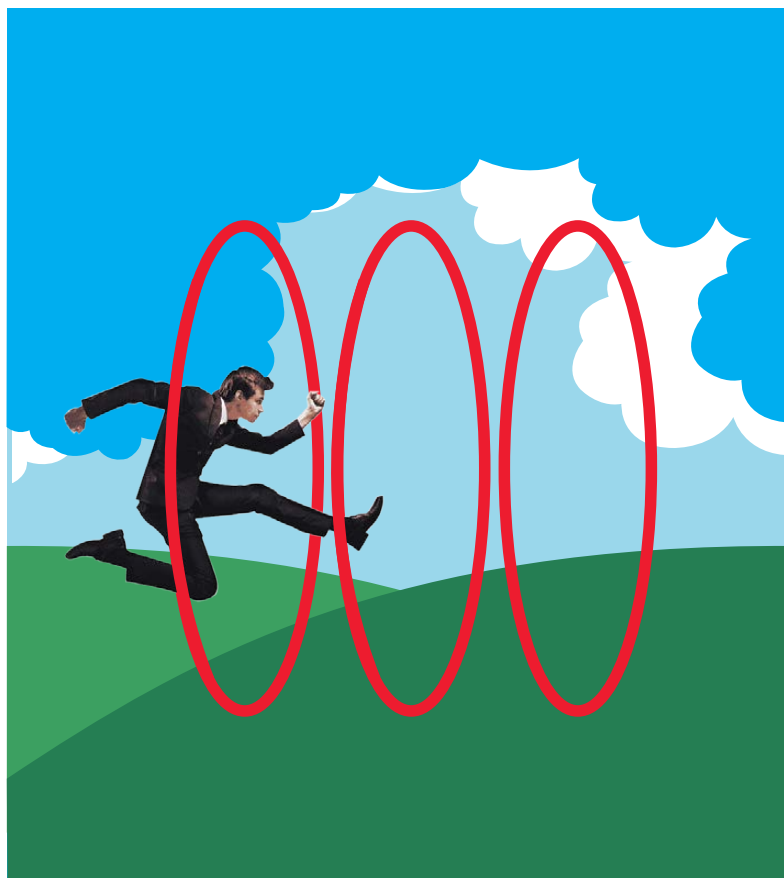


ILLUSTRATION BY ANIRBAN GHOSH

ity, and promoting public health initiatives. India needs to focus on preventive and curative healthcare, ensuring every citizen has access to quality health services. The government has taken several steps to make healthcare in India 'affordable and inclusive'.

A national healthcare strategy focused on digital health, nutrition, and other high-impact interventions has fast-forwarded health outcomes across India. The 'Ayushman Bharat Yojana' is a bold initiative the government took to shift from a segmented, sectoral approach towards comprehensive, need-based healthcare services. The initiative aims to holistically address all aspects of healthcare,

including the prevention of diseases, promotion of healthcare facilities and ambulatory care at the primary, secondary and tertiary levels.

The concerted strategy of combining policy reforms, investments in human capital, and technological innovation will play a catalytic role in the coming years. Focusing on the three pillars of innovation, infrastructure, and human capital will ensure that the country realises its true potential and contributes significantly to the world as a leading power in the 21st century. **BT**

The author is Managing Director of Sun Pharma. Views are personal